

in no way slow, it would be wiser to stick with cheap SATA drives and opt for a faster CPU or graphics card instead. Storage always gets cheaper over time.

OS

From a practical point of view, it doesn't really matter as long as you have all the necessary drivers configured correctly. Users have recorded considerably faster Cycles render times on Linux distros but Linux has a history of proprietary driver issues with GPUs. A lot of work has been done to address this issue and it has indeed improved but if you're not familiar with Linux ecosystem you should better stick with the one you're currently using. But if you're enthusiastic about switching, consider widely used and stable Linux distros like Ubuntu or Arch as they have better support for drivers and a comparatively large user-base which forms an active and welcoming community to help out amateur users if you happen to encounter driver issues or 'Linux-only' problems.

Power Supply (PSU)

An underpowered or overpowered PSU will unavoidably damage your build. This problem is made worse if the PSU is not well made. Unless you're an electrical engineer the smart thing to do would be to take help from an expert. Don't risk ruining your several-hundred dollars equipment. Get a high-quality PSU. As opposed to other parts of a PC the quality of power supplies increases at a sluggish rate with time. A one-time investment in high-quality power supply rig today, will buy you peace of mind for the next 5 to 10 years. 